Your College Choice: More Than Just a Major.

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What I Thought College Was About

When I first started college, I thought it was mostly about picking a major, taking classes, and getting a degree. I didn't really think about how much the experience would shape the way I think or what kind of person I'd become. The focus was always on job prep, not on what kind of values or awareness I might walk out with. I saw core classes as just something to get through, not something that might actually shift how I view the world.

How Jesuit Education Changed My Mindset

- Saw core classes as boring “checklist” at first
- Started questioning who benefits from certain systems
- Learned that education can build values, not just knowledge
- Connected my interests (like cybersecurity) to bigger issues
- Realized that ethical choices matter in technical fields
- Shifted from “just pass the class” to “what impact can I have?”

What Kind of Future Am I Building?

I used to think the future was just about picking a job, learning the skills, and staying on track. But now I see it's more than that. It's also about asking good questions, knowing what kind of systems I want to support, and thinking about the kind of impact I want to have. I care about fairness, about helping people trust what they use, and about making tech easier to understand. This class made me realize I don't just want to build things. I want to build tools that actually help people, and feel human.

How It Changed My View of Tech

Before this class, I used to think being good at cybersecurity was all about hiding things and locking everything down. Now I see that real security can come from being open, from letting users actually see what's going on with their data and giving them control over it. I don't just focus on building secure systems anymore, I think about making them fair, honest, and something people can actually trust. That shift means a lot to me because I want to do work that helps people, not just protects code.

A New Way of Seeing Core Classes

At first, I saw core classes as a checklist, just boxes I had to check off to graduate. I didn't really connect them to what I cared about or wanted to do. But this course changed that. We talked about power, privacy, and systems that affect our everyday lives. It helped me connect classroom learning to real-world issues and made me care more about what kind of impact I want to have with what I'm learning.

What This Class Gave Me

- Helped me think deeper about systems I used to take for granted
- Made me see how power and control show up in tech, education, and beyond
- Got me thinking more critically about the stories we're told
- Taught me to question assumptions, even the ones I thought were facts
- Helped me connect my interests in tech with real-world impact
- Showed me that ethics and empathy belong in tech work too
- Gave me the confidence to imagine and build better systems

Final Reflection

I used to think success meant being a great coder or staying on top of the newest tools, always chasing the next update. But now I see that is only part of the picture. Tech also needs people who care about fairness, who take time to listen, and who think about the impact of what they are building, not just whether it works. I want to be one of those people, someone who asks better questions, who chooses clarity over confusion, and who helps others feel more in control of the tools they use. This class showed me that being good at something is not just about skill, it is also about the values you bring to your work. The way I think has changed, and now I care more about the kind of future I want to help create. That shift in thinking feels like the most valuable thing I am taking from this class. It is not just a mindset, it is motivation.